

NYC-Style Bagels

Straight dough · short ~3h bulk → shape → **emphasized pan proof** → cold hold · boiled & baked

YIELD	FLOUR	HYDRATION	METHOD	TOTAL DOUGH
24 @ 150g	Sir Lancelot 14.2%	60%	Straight + bulk	~3,630g

STRAIGHT DOUGH

No poolish — mix it all at once

Sir Lancelot	2,200 g	Honey (~2.5%)	55 g
Water (60% — cold if warm kitchen)	1,320 g	ADY (0.6%)	13.2 g
Salt (2%)	44 g		

The flour's malted barley supplies the enzyme load. **0.6% ADY targets a ~4.5h total room ferment** (~3h bulk + ~1.5h pan proof) — ~6× the pizza 0.2% because this runs ~5× faster. Derived against the TXCraig1 yeast model at a granite-cooled ~66°F effective bulk temp. Start here; if the bulk hits 50% well before 3h, drop toward 0.4% — if it drags, the granite's colder than figured, nudge up or extend.

MIX

Two batches — incorporation only, then fold

Mix straight, then divide by weight for the stretch-and-fold. Each batch makes 12 bagels.

PER MIXING BATCH ×2

Flour	1,100 g
Water	660 g
Salt	22 g
Honey	27.5 g
ADY	6.6 g

Mixer = incorporation only. At 60% with 14.2% flour the hook can't reach windowpane — gluten's too strong to fully develop in the machine. Run low just until combined, no dry bits, then stop.

Develop by stretch-and-fold: 2–3 S&F sets ~30 min apart through the first ~1.5h of bulk; the rests autolyse, the folds build the network. **Windowpane is a post-fold check.** Low-friction mixing in a 70°F room lands the dough near room temp (~68–70°F) — already factored into the yeast and bulk timing.

~1,815g dough per batch → 12 bagels @ 150g.

The consistency lever: shaping from a **bulk-fermented mass** — not pre-divided pieces — is why pro bagels come out even without a scale. A short bulk organizes the gluten across the whole dough so each piece ropes uniformly. This is the structural reason for the fork.

TEMP TARGETS

this stage — mix & dough

Room (dough rests here)	70°F	Dough after mix	~68–70°F
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Execution & Read

ROOM (BULK+PROOF)	BULK PULL	BOIL BATH	BAKE
70°F	~50% rise	212°F roll	450°F

BULK · SHAPE · PROOF · HOLD

- Short bulk, ~3 h:** mix in the morning, bulk on the counter **to ~50% rise**. Run **2–3 S&F sets, 30 min apart**, through the first ~1.5 h; rest after. The bulk's job is to **organize the gluten**, not to do the main proof — pull by rise, not clock.
- Divide from the bulk** to 150g (cut from the organized mass — the consistency move). Pre-round, bench rest **10–15 min**, then **rope & weld TIGHT**: fuse the seam on un-floured counter, small ~1.5" hole = puffs up, not out.
- Pan proof — THIS is the main proof, ~1–2 h:** rise the shaped bagels on half-sheets at 70°F **to final height**. This is the rise that makes the bagel; weight it here, not in the bulk. Float-test when they look ready.
- Fridge = HOLD, not proof.** Bagels go in **already proofed**; expect ~no rise (this fridge doesn't proof). Cold-hold for flavor + scheduling, then boil straight from cold (brief temper for the chill).

Granite note: cold counter is a heat-sink — it slows the bulk (good, keeps it partial) but unevenly. Bulk in a **bowl** for even temp if you want; the pan proof runs warmer (pan buffers the counter) which is why it finishes the rise.

BOIL & BAKE

- Float test** straight from cold: surfaces in ~10s → go. Sinks → temper at room temp, retest. **This gates everything.**
- Boil bath:** per ~7 L water add **45 g baking soda + 40 g honey**. Gentle rolling boil, never violent.
- Boil 30 sec / side.** Shorter boil = thinner, more tender crust. Seed wet, straight out of the water (everything blend).
- Bake 450°F** on a **half-sheet pan** (parchment + cornmeal), **8 per pan**. Steam the first few min. **Steel goes one rack BELOW the pan with an air gap** — radiant mass, NOT touching the pan (pan-on-steel dries the heel). **~18 min total: flip the bagels on the pan at the halfway point** — gives the heel relief from bottom heat and evens both faces. Judge by set + even color.
- Rest 20–30 min** before cutting. Hot crumb reads false-gummy.

BROWNING MECHANISM

Solved — no malt syrup required

Honey deposits a sugar film → **Maillard** fuel; baking soda drives the surface **alkaline**, accelerating it (pretzel chemistry). Together they cover the color the absent malt would give. Deeper mahogany: bake the soda 300°F/1h → sodium carbonate, then use in the bath.

DIAGNOSTICS

Dull, soft, over-sprung	Under-boiled — skin never set. Add boil time.
Wrinkled, tough, squat, gummy ring under skin	Over-boiled — skin set too hard, strangled spring. Cut boil time.
Skin right, interior gummy	Under-baked. Add 2–3 min; leave boil alone.
Tough bite, tight crumb	Under-proofed. Extend the bulk or the shaped room-temp rise; the fridge won't proof it. Float-test before boiling.
Tough, dried heel; soft top	Pan sitting directly on the steel — conduction cooks the heel all bake. Put an air gap (steel a rack below), and flip at halfway to give the heel relief.
Tough crumb, worse when toasted	Moisture-starved — 60% is the tenderness floor .